

HANA TECH CON 2026 · COMMUNITY KEYNOTE

From Bold Promises to Operational Reality

*From the beginning of HANA to Everything on HANA
- 14 years of keeping it simple.*

Christian Braukmüller

Evonik Industries AG

SAP Mentor 🚀

Community by heart 💛



Agenda

Two perspectives — one journey.

PERSPECTIVE **COMMUNITY** *My community journey with SAP HANA*

1

The first SAP HANA book — a TCO fairy tale and what it taught me

Shoutouts — The people who accompanied, motivated and influenced me

PERSPECTIVE **IMPLEMENTATION** *My implementation experience in reality*

2

Evonik: HANA in the real world — The setting, early adoption, KISS, performance, automation

3

Outlook & wishes

PERSPECTIVE COMMUNITY · CHAPTER 1

2012: The first SAP HANA book The TCO chapter

Reading while being at one of the first SAP HANA trainings in Walldorf.

Spoiler: I had questions.



The TCO chapter

do a poor job of writing a good business case. Therefore, most of these writers should review their business case with a financial analyst, business planner, or senior manager before calling a meeting and requesting a budget.

Total Cost of Ownership (TCO)

It's important to acknowledge that a *significant* initial investment is required for SAP HANA when compared to a traditional database and server strategy. However, when compared with the costs of maintaining, upgrading, patching, and paying license fees for databases, application servers, database servers, connectivity and security support in many platforms, as well as daily monitoring of multiple systems, the investment in SAP HANA becomes more reasonable.

For example, the average database administrator (DBA) in the United States is paid \$78,239, according to the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, whereas the average DBA in Europe is paid around \$64,000. In SAP HANA, DBAs aren't needed, resulting in significant operational savings. Also, the average SAP NetWeaver BW developer in a company is paid approximately \$65,000 to \$85,000 per year, while some consultants charge as much as \$225 per hour. These developers are building InfoCubes,



The TCO chapter



For example, the average database administrator (DBA) in the United States is paid \$78,239, according to the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, whereas the average DBA in Europe is paid around \$64,000. In SAP HANA, DBAs aren't needed, resulting in significant operational savings.

The promise: low TCO, zero DBAs

What the book said

"In SAP HANA, DBAs aren't needed - resulting in significant operational savings."

What it implied

The database would run itself. Admins: please find a new hobby.

What I did

Sent feedback to SAP PRESS and SAP. Politely. Mostly.

What they said

Yes - that was the intended message at the time.



@CBasis
@CBasis



@Pennysilvia I think the TCO-section in #SAPPress HANA needs a review. Any chance to discuss that somewhere?



Ergebnisse aus dem Buch:
SAP HANA

2 Treffer (von 2 Treffern im Buch)

Seite 131: ... * BC-DB-HDB-DBA SAP HANA database/DBA cockpit* ... [Seite anzeigen]
Relevanz: 100%

Seite 99: ... *For example, the average database administrator (DBA) in the United States is paid*\$78,239, according to the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, whereas the average DBA ... *in Europe is paid around \$64,000. In SAP HANA, DBAs aren't needed, resulting in*significant operational savings. Also, the average SAP NetWeaver BW developer in ... [Seite anzeigen]
Relevanz: 91%

12:07 AM · Feb 21, 2013

Twitter was the place to be at that time.

WAS IT TRUE?

No.



But the talks were good for something

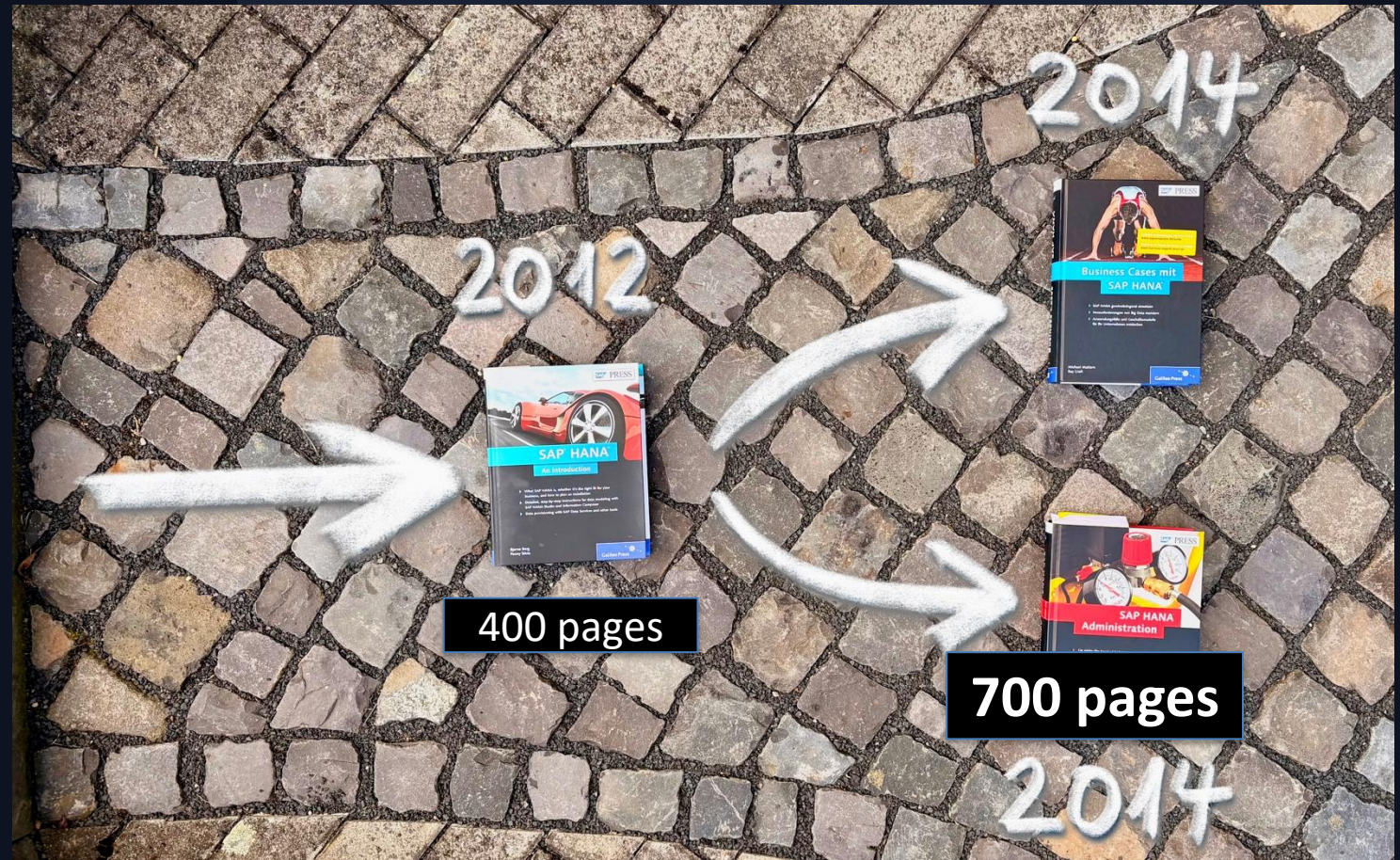
Feedback landed. The next edition of the book was changed.

Two years later: A new book



But the talks were good for something

Feedback landed. The next edition of the book was changed.





But the talks were good for something

Feedback landed. The next edition of the book was changed.



The situation changed me too

My own mindset shifted - from grumbling to contributing.

Finally started influencing.

Every new tech ships with prophecies

HANA

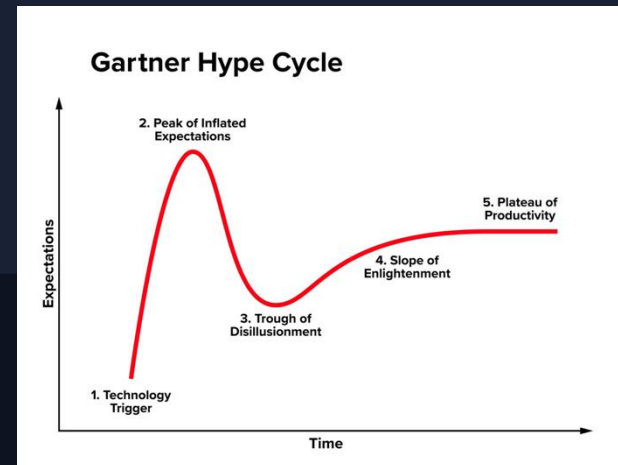
Cloud

AI

It takes time until a promised expectation is adjusted or neutralized by real-world experience.

But the promise usually outlives the reality check - it sticks in people's heads.

And that makes it harder to prioritize the real challenges in companies.



Every new tech ships with prophecies

HANA

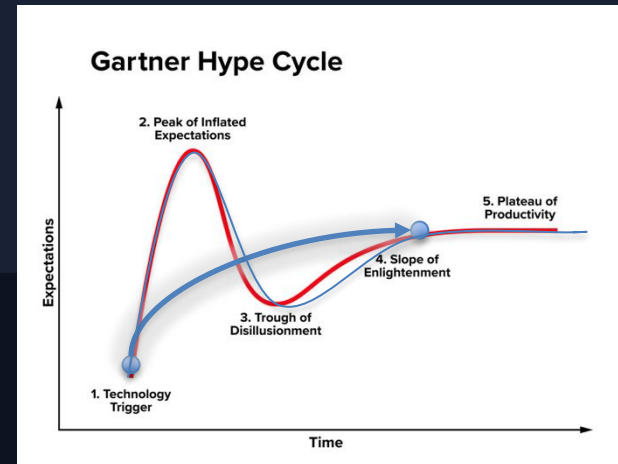
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PERSPECTIVE COMMUNITY

7 Shoutouts.

The people who helped me to get through the hype cycle - and the community formats they stand for.



Hasso Plattner

OPENHPI

The professor who shared the facts to the community

A company founder, lecturing online, for free - explaining why row storage was holding us all back. ("In-Memory Data Management", 2012)

openHPI

openHPI - free, open online lectures straight from the source.

Course	Lecturer	Language	Term
In-Memory Data Management	Prof. Hasso Plattner	English	2012-09-03 to 2012-10-28
Internetworking mit TCP/IP	Prof. Dr. Christoph Meinel	German	2012-11-05 to 2012-12-24
Semantic Web Technologies	Dr. Harald Sack	English	2013-02-04 to 2013-04-01
Datenmanagement mit SQL	Prof. Dr. Felix Naumann	German	2013-04-08 to 2013-05-27
Web-Technologien	Prof. Dr. Christoph Meinel	German	2013-06-03 to 2013-07-22

openHPI course catalog, 2012. Row 1: where it all began.





Thomas Jung

The helping hand of Madrid

Middle of InnoJam chaos, he sat down and helped me connecting our ABAP trial to a SAP HANA trial. No fuss. It just worked. (SAP InnoJam Madrid, 2012)

Then he taught the rest of us

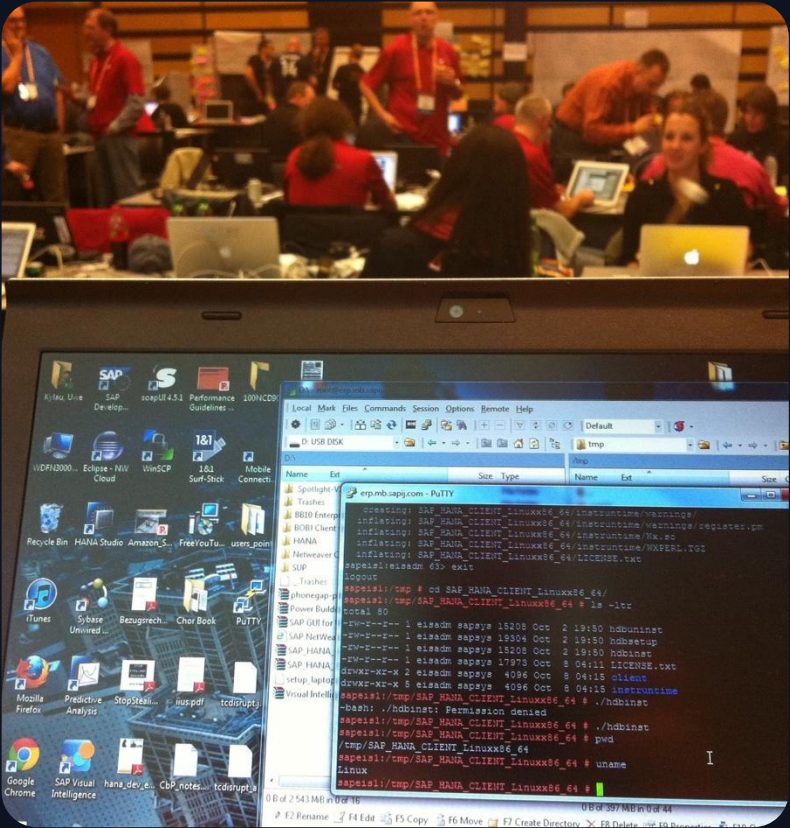
openSAP: “SAP HANA Native Application Basics” - patient, hands-on, endlessly practical.

INNOJAM / DEMOJAM

openSAP

InnoJam / DemoJam

InnoJam / DemoJam - build all night, demo in six minutes.



SAP InnoJam 2012 - laptops, lanyards, zero sleep



Mark Finnern

“Enterprise IT can be serious and fun at the same time.”

He didn't say it - he showed it. Every year within the Mentors program.
(SAP Mentors program lead at this time)

What that did for me

It gave me room for creativity. Permission to experiment, to be creative, to support unusual ideas in a serious enterprise industry - and to raise the quality bar even higher.



SAP MENTORS

SAP INSIDE TRACKS

SAP Inside Tracks

SAP Inside Tracks - community-organized, weekend-powered, knowledge sharing at eye level.





Lars Breddemann

The deep-dive answers

Blog posts and forum answers that explained what HANA was actually doing under the hood.

Reading his content felt like a masterclass

And it was free, searchable and always honest.

SAP COMMUNITY BLOGS

SAP Community Blogs

SAP Community Network Blogs and Forum- where the real documentation happens.





SAP NOTES

Martin Frauendorfer

Deep database expertise, carried over

From his previous DB world into SAP HANA.

The operational backbone

His notes and SQL statement collection are what make running HANA performant in the first place.
Version 806 already!

SAP Notes

SAP Notes - that could be a book

←

→

↺

me.sap.com/notes/1969700

☰

SAP

SAP for Me

1969700

🏠

👤

📅

📊

💰

Services & Support / KBAs & Notes / SAP HANA / SAP HANA Database (HAN-DB)

1969700 - SQL Statement Collection for SAP HANA

SAP Note, Version: 806, Released On: 13.07.2026

Component: HAN-DB

Category: Consulting

Correction: 0

Priority: Recommendations / Additional Info

Release Status: Released to Customer

Manual Activities: 0

Prerequisites: 0

SAP Note/KBA



Hans-Peter Seitz & Jörg Brandeis

HANA TECHNIGHT

Keeping the community fire burning - onsite

Connecting all areas of HANA skills in one community event

Practitioners sharing real stories

No marketing slides - but pizza.

HANA TechNight

HANA TechNight - inspired by the SAP Inside Track concept, but took off with its own focused identity.



HANA TechNight



Jens Gleichmann

Performance and operations wisdom

Generously shared with the community.

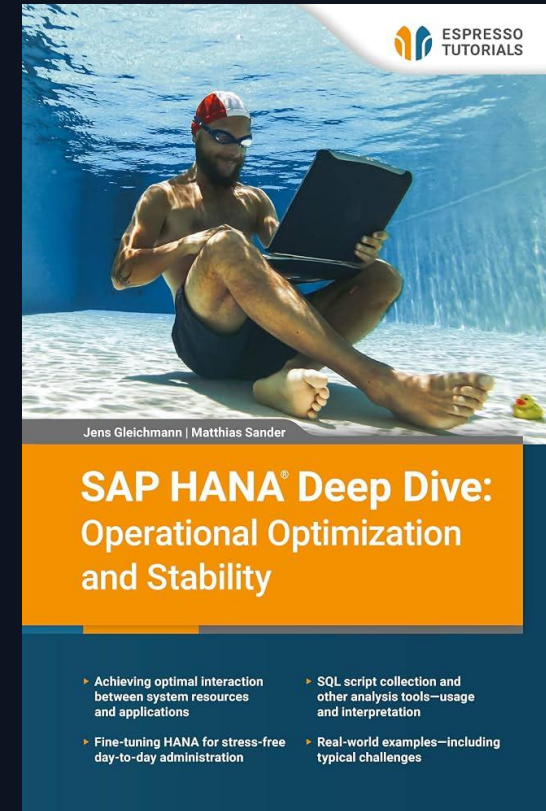
“Now we finally have the books we were told we would never need.”

DSAG Lectures

THE HANA BOOKS

The HANA books

The HANA books - from “no need for admins” to a book full of operations knowledge.



- ▶ Achieving optimal interaction between system resources and applications
- ▶ Fine-tuning HANA for stress-free day-to-day administration
- ▶ SQL script collection and other analysis tools—usage and interpretation
- ▶ Real-world examples—including typical challenges

BEFORE WE DIVE IN

Who's talking?

BEFORE WE DIVE IN

Who's talking?



BEFORE WE DIVE IN

Who's talking?

TODAY

Christian Braukmüller · Teamlead SAP Landscape Architecture at Evonik



BEFORE

9 years growing up with SAP R/3
Provider, Internal IT, Consultant

17 years as a freelancer

Since 2020 Evonik

COMMUNITY

SAP Mentor since 2014.



DSAG

German SAP user group
Active as a spokesman for SAP BTP



SAP Stammtisch
Frankfurt

SAP Inside Track

SAP TechEd Speaker

UI5con

reCAP

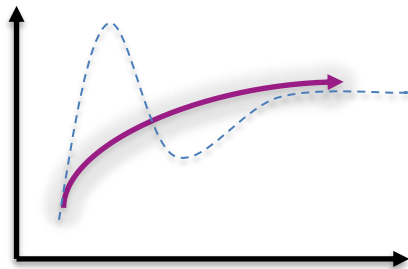
DSAG
SAP BTP



PERSPECTIVE IMPLEMENTATION

The customer story: Evonik

From one appliance to “all SAP systems on HANA”
- driven by DatabaseAdmins and Systemarchitects ;)



Evonik

1

The company

Chemical industry - specialty chemicals: global, 24/7 production business.

2

The SAP platform

Running SAP end-to-end: OnPrem, SAP BTP and SAP SaaS products.

Around 100 Systems based on SAP HANA

3

The team setup

The SAP database team is part of the SAP Basis team, focused on SAP HANA - same department as SAP Development and SAP Authorizations. Covering three timezones.

HOW WE WORK

Team SAP Landscape Architecture is responsible for e.g. SAP HANA, SAP Infrastructure, SAP Automation, SAP BTP, SAP Integration, SAP Connectivity, SAP Security.

Database Team: Very close contact within the team: automation and infrastructure skills side by side.
Direct line to the delivery managers of the SAP applications on top.
Short paths: Basis, Development and Authorizations under one roof.

Early adopter: from appliance to SAP HANA TDI

Starting with an appliance

One box. Much curiosity.
Careful first steps.
Learning about the setup.

Momentum

System by system migrates.
ALL systems .. even the small ones.



First productive systems

Business Warehouse leads the way - trust grows with every quarter.

Reconstructing to a TDI landscape to scale.

Naming conventions are important

Today

All SAP systems on HANA. The appliance era is history - a virtualized TDI environment is our platform.

Migration of the core ERP System to S/4HANA in 2021.

Continuous learning path with changing workload over the time.



Keep it simple. Seriously.

KISS as an architecture decision, not an accident

1

No system replication

The know-how exists. The need didn't. We skipped the complexity - on purpose.

2

No scale-out

One node, fewer moving parts, fewer surprises. Scale-up carried us fine.

3

OneVM for One SAP System

All Application Instances PLUS SAP HANA
On the same VM (virtual host)

Clean and predictable.
Stability and performance by adaptivity

Complexity you don't build is complexity you don't debug at 3 a.m.

99,95 99,98

Availability



HANA virtualization & adaptivity: Now we are talking TCO

Workloads change. Constantly – Predictable.

New use cases, new interfaces, new peaks - the platform absorbed them.

Adaptivity was an early clean core guardrail

There is no dependency of the application towards the underlying layer
- and if there is a need, than it will be defined to work.

Adaptivity is a TCO feature

High flexibility in addition to the Virtualization layer.

Adaptivity

The ability to decouple applications from the underlying Operating System – gives flexibility on an additional layer.

Application Instances

Adaptivity

Linux

Virtualization

Hardware



Performance: Ups and downs ... glad we have the admins



Years of curves

Every major change came with new learnings by **DB-Administrators**.



Latency, ABAPmeter

From “feels slow” to microsecond-level truth.



HEX engine

New engine, new behaviour, new homework



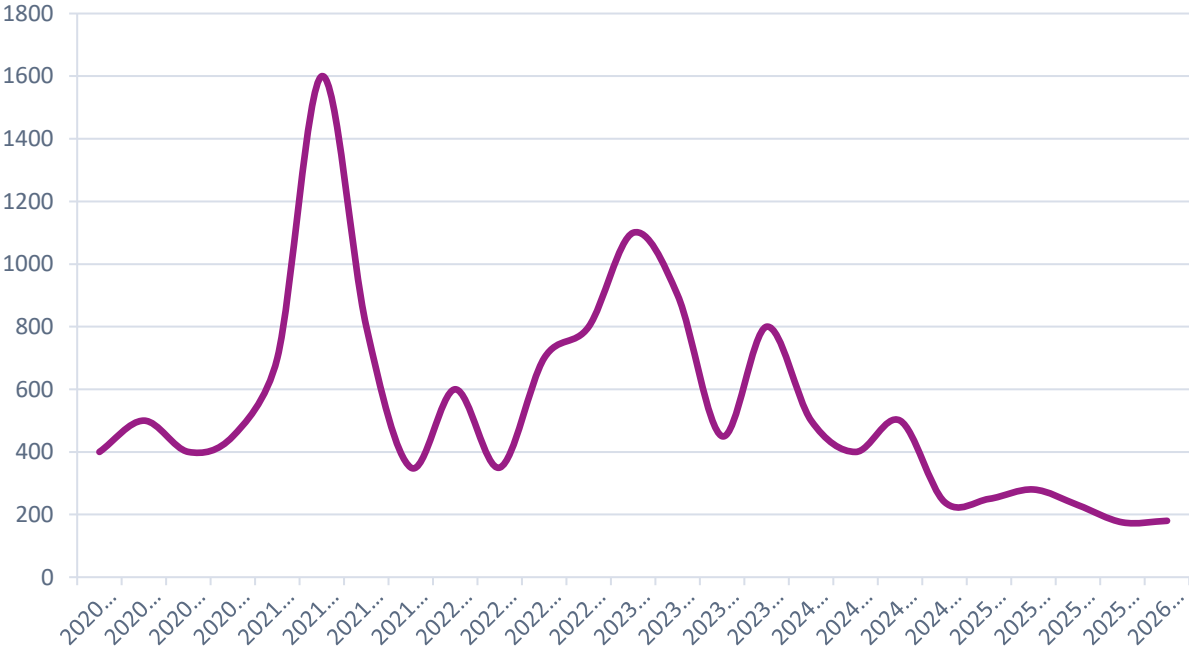
Capture & Replay

Setting up and using it for major changes



HCMT

Custom-automated scalable Load-Tests – testing maximum peaks

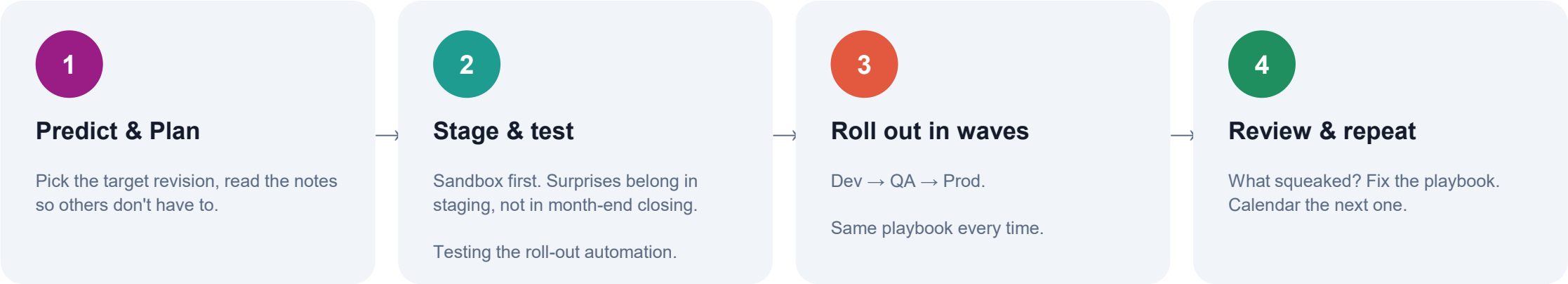


— HANA DB Times

- S/4HANA migration and two upgrades
- several HANA updates
- one Hardware Renewal (in 2024)
- Relocation to OneVM (in 2026)



The HANA upgrade cycle: scheduled over surprise mode



THINK LIKE A PROVIDER

Play it like a public cloud provider.
Stay ahead of the wave.
Define your own schedule - and make it transparent to everyone.
Predictable down-times and change-windows are the foundation of synchronisation over the whole landscape.

*It's easier to handle exceptions in a standardized process
- than to standardize an environment shaped by exceptions.*



Security hardening: Not so much “Secure-by-Default”

ENCRYPTION JOURNEY - ON MULTIPLE LEVELS

- 1 Backup
- 2 Online Logs
- 3 Data
- 4 Connections

MICRO-SEGMENTATION

System communication directed by guardrails

Standardization pays off – Security by rules

Protecting your crown jewels on every layer.



Hot topics as of now: clean core & vibe code

CLEAN CORE

Guardrails so the core stays upgradeable:

- Allowed access - defined, not assumed
- Governance that guides instead of blocks
- API Policy and ODP restrictions
- Extensions where they belong (ABAP Cloud OnPrem)

VIBE-CODING TRANSPARENCY

Small AI-built tools and reporting
that answer the questions currently not be answered by dashboards:

- Backup at scale: start and run times at a glance
- Plugins & delivery units inventory
- Client versions across the fleet
- Upgrade planning, de-spreadsheeted



OUTLOOK

What's next on the list



Cloud readiness — Supporting our Clean Core & Public Cloud. Strategy.



Hybrid standards — Extending our on-prem automation mindset towards SAP BTP: Terraform.



Licenses & costs — Usage-based charging was the expectation in the Cloud



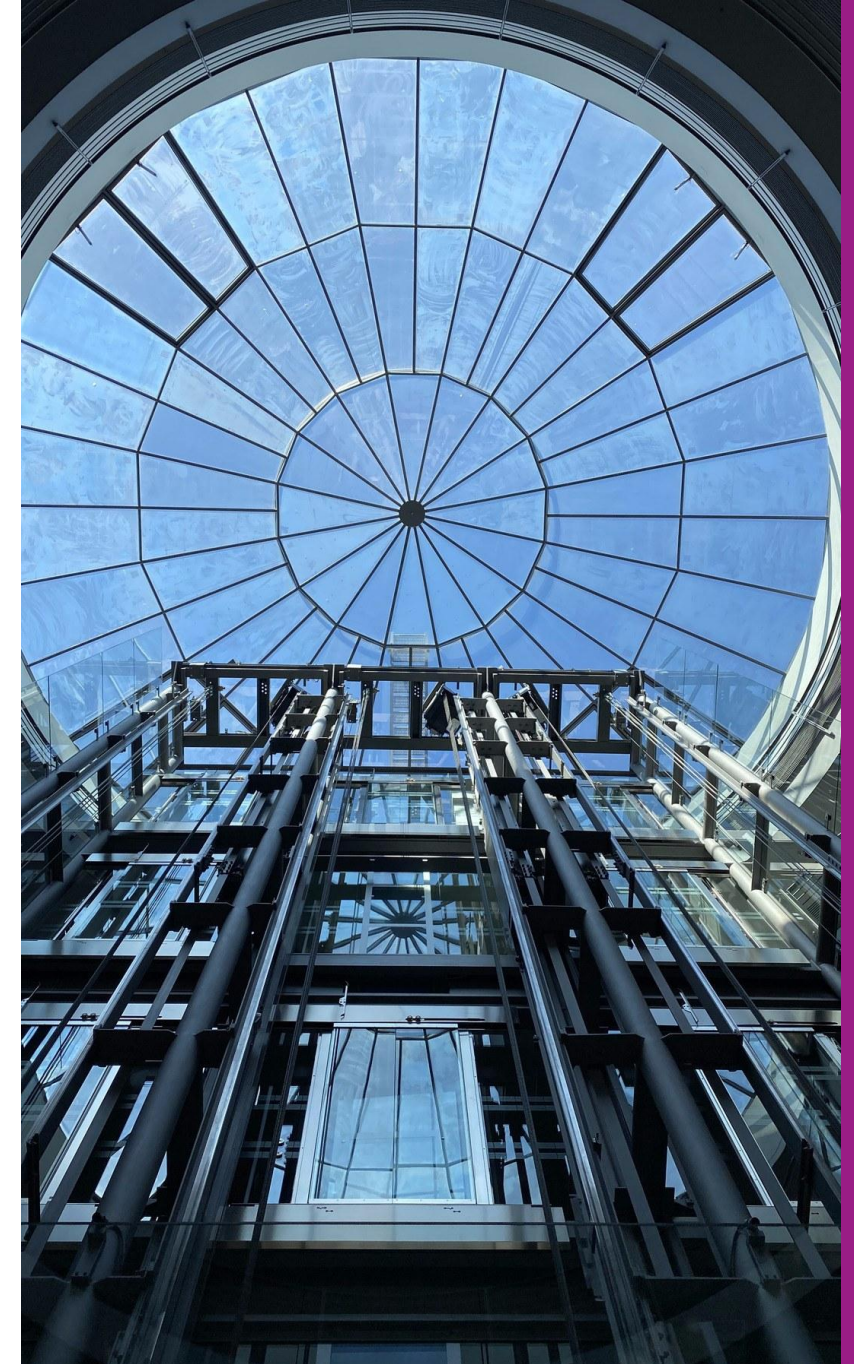
Outage handling — Claiming and ITSM Synchronization



Governance that keeps pace — Development speeds up. Compliance can't fall behind.



More out of AI — Reports, dashboards, insights, maybe agents and MCP.





Take aways & Wishlist

1

Community rocks

Every DemoJam, Tech Night, Councils and post-it event pays off for the product adoption

2

Promises $\neq$ value

Keep prophecies grounded.

3

Keep it simple

The architecture you don't build never wakes you at 3 a.m.

All that is build on top will bring it's own complexity anyhow.

4

Share what you learn

Feedback changed a book, and makes events like today possible.

5

Request to SAP : Invest strongly into the contact with the community.

The community is the product challenger and gives valuable feedback – for a product to succeed.

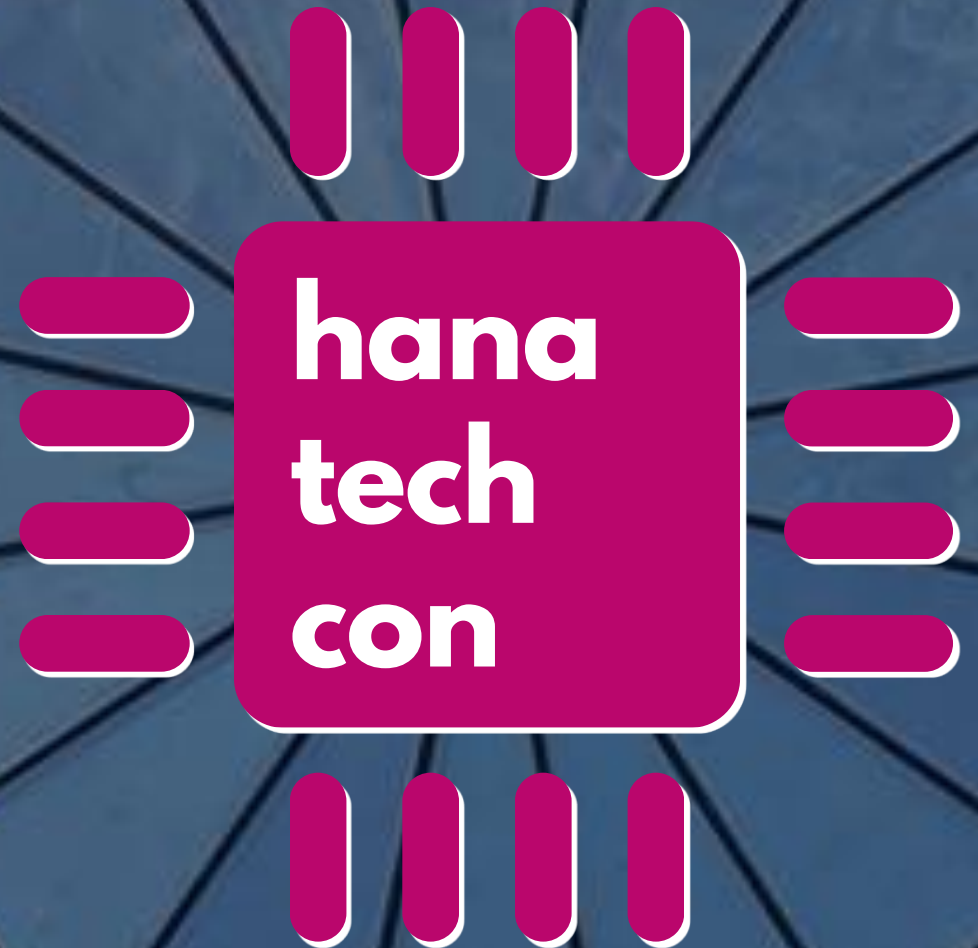
SAP HANA (OnPrem) will still be the foundation for a huge number of customers.

Provide as much deep dive information as possible and documentation, and community will follow.

„Whether you're shaping data strategy, writing the code, or scaling HANA in production - this is your space to connect, exchange ideas, and help shape what comes next“

Stefan Bäuerle

Senior Vice President, Head of SAP HANA & Persistency





2019
Walldorf



Breakout Sessions
and Usability Tests
D2 and D6
SAP HANA
Operation
Expert Summit

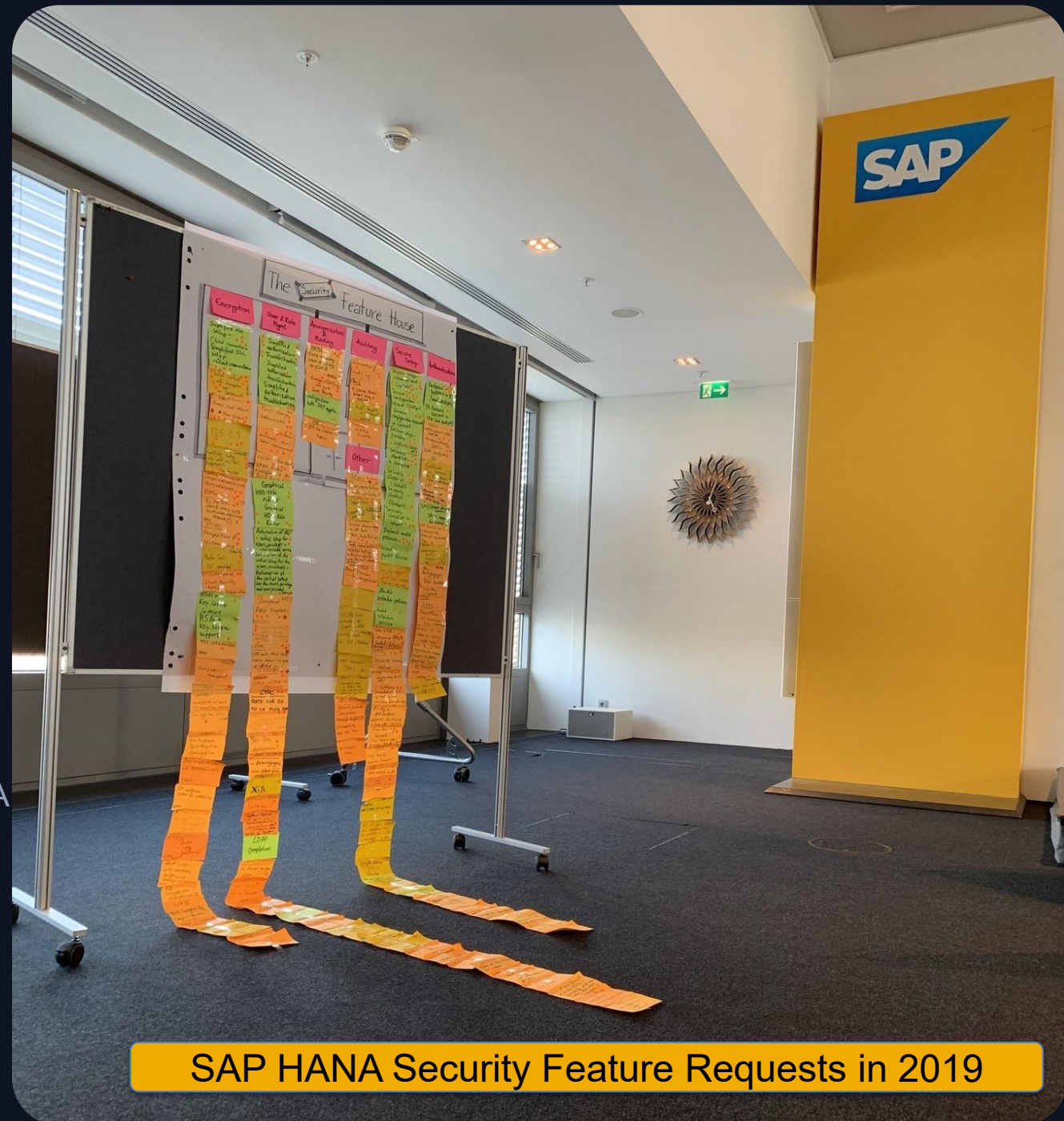
Thank you.

To everyone here being a part of the community,
sharing his | her perspective of SAP HANA.

In 2012 there was no indication
that we would have written so many post-its for SAP HANA

Christian

Enjoy this special day.



SAP HANA Security Feature Requests in 2019

